



MINUTES

The fourteenth meeting of the Student Government Association of Western Kentucky University was called to order at 5:05pm on December 2, 2003 with the Executive Vice President in the chair

A motion to approve the minutes was made. Seconded. *Motion approved unanimously.*

There were 25 members out of 43 present.

President John Bradley

- The plus/minus grading rally was held on November 20. I am pretty happy with the outcome. It was sent to a committee. Plus/minus grading is still an issue. We will not let up.

Executive Vice President Patti Johnson

- There are five pieces of legislation up for second reading.
- Look at the proposed Constitution carefully. We don't want any mistakes in it.

Vice President of Finance Nick Todd

- There is an updated budget. If you have any questions, ask me.

Vice President of Public Relations Abby Lovan

- A picture will be taken for the yearbook at the banquet.

Vice President of Administration Jessica Martin

- No report.

Committee Reports

Coordinator of Committees-Scott Wolfe

-No report.

Academic Affairs-Natalie Croney

-No report.

Campus Improvements-Shawn Peavie

-Two pieces of legislation up for second reading.

Legislative Research-Robert Watkins

-Met Monday at 5pm in the SGA office.

-We now have the real Constitution that was supposed to be read last week.



Public Relations-Brittany Fausey and Evelina Petkova

- The jump table went well.
- There will be no meeting this week.

Student Affairs-Katie Dawson and Tim Howard

- Will meet Thursday at 5pm to go eat.

Information Technology Director

Posted some minutes.

Special Orders

Swore in one new Congress member.

Judicial Council report

- Went over the constitution.
- Was asked to rule on three interpretations. In the first ruling, we were asked what a complete semester of membership was. We decided that if someone was sworn in after the fourth Congress meeting, they did not serve a full semester. For the second ruling, we were asked about exemptions and what constitutes an exemption when running for an executive office. We decided that each case was different and the person needs to have knowledge of the Constitution. For the third ruling, we were asked to review John Bradley's action of making attendance mandatory for the rally. We ruled that he did violate the Constitution in doing so. No member of another governmental body can order anyone in another body to do something.

University Senate report

Met the Thursday before Thanksgiving. The faculty was impressed with the turnout. The proposal was sent to committee. Josh Collins and Troy Ransdell will serve on the Academic Quality Ad Hoc Committee. The committee will discuss issues other than plus/minus grading.

Unfinished Business

Bill 03-10-F New Constitution and Bylaws

Robert Watkins defended the legislation saying that the old constitution has too many problems. He said that when he was writing the constitution he took everyone's ideas into account and tried to make everybody happy in the process. During questions, Hollan Holm asked what maniple meant? Watkins said that it meant flexible or could be changed. (Note: A maniple is actually a silk oriental, a roman legion subdivision, or a napkin. The word will be amended at the next meeting to malleable.) Robert Reynolds asked if the discriminatory clause could be amended to be more specific. Watkins said if that was what Congress wanted to do, then yes. Troy Ransdell asked if another work could be cited in the Constitution. Watkins said that if it pertained to the subject, a work could be cited. John Bradley asked if we could make the President a meritus position. Watkins said no. *There was a motion and a second to approve.* There was no debate. *The bill passed with general consent.*

Resolution 03-11-F Re-graveling the SkyPAC Parking Lot

Shawn Peavie defended the legislation saying that the idea came from Greg Fear. Fear said that when things are pushed by SGA things get pushed up. During questions, Cameron Yancey asked why we couldn't pave it. Peavie said that it was going to be something else later on and that it wasn't ours. Katie Dawson said that SkyPAC was not in the long-term plan. She said that the University was only using it until they were ready to build the Southern Kentucky Performing Arts Center. *There was a motion and a second to approve.* In debate there was an amendment to take out "graveling in this" in the second whereas clause. *The resolution passed unanimously.*

Bill 03-12-F SGA Adopt-A-Tree Program

Shawn Peavie defended the legislation. He said that the trees would come from a company that the University uses. He said that the trees were all ready purchased and that it would just be a recycling of money. Peavie said that it was a good way for people to get involved with the school and SGA. During questions, Robert Watkins asked Peavie to explain the money situation. Peavie said that since we get money from the University it would just be going back for the trees. *There was a motion and a second to approve.* In debate, Brittany Fausey's name was amended to be spelled correctly. John Law said that we get our money from a Student Activities fee and that it shouldn't be going to buy trees that have all ready been purchased. *The bill passed with general consent.*

Resolution 03-14-F Private Information Security

Katie Dawson defended the legislation saying that students' information shouldn't be available for everybody to see. She said things have happened because this information was out there. She said that the University Senate did this earlier this semester. *There was a motion and a second to approve.* In debate, there was an amendment made to add Robert Watkins to the authors list. There was also an amendment to change the line "that all student addresses availability" to "that access student addresses, both on and off campus," in the purpose clause. John Law said that the TAC wanted to put the directory under TopNet. He said that he thought people would pull out of the directory. He said Congress should table the resolution and write one for putting the directory under TopNet. Tim Howard said that people would only take their addresses out of the directory and that you could still call them and ask the person information. Robert Watkins asked Law how long it would take for IT to switch the directory to TopNet. Law said that it could be done by late next semester. John Bradley said that right now people can opt out of having their information posted but there was a lot of paperwork involved. *The resolution passed with general consent.*

Resolution 03-15-F Hooded Sweatshirts

Katie Dawson defended the legislation saying that SGA had money left over in the t-shirt part of the budget and members should be rewarded for their outstanding hard work. In questions, John Law asked why PR wasn't a sponsor of the legislation. Dawson said there was going to be an amendment in debate to add the committee. Law asked if they had approved it. Dawson said they had. *There was a motion and a second to approve.* In debate, there was an amendment to add the PR committee to the sponsors list. Hollan Holm asked how many shirts could be bought with the money in the budget. Abby Lovan said that it depended on the design and color of the shirt. John Law said that we shouldn't be using student fee money to buy ourselves hooded sweatshirts and if we do we should give them to random students. Matthew Pava said that as it was written, it was not specified who was going to get the shirts. Michael Holcomb suggested that we compromise by giving some to Congress members and some to the student body. One Congress member said that giving the shirts to random students wouldn't be anything but a waste of money because it wouldn't mean anything to them. He said it would just be a free shirt to them. John Bradley said that according to the Constitution, every student was a member of SGA, so the shirts could go to anyone that was a student. *The resolution passed with general consent.*

New Business

NONE

Announcements

John Bradley announced that the spring retreat was going to be in Louisville on January 30. The trip is going to cost \$2000, which is what we usually spend. The cost covers renting vans, hotel, food, and meeting space. There was a motion and a second to approve the expenditures for the retreat. The motion passed.

There will be a cabaret in Gordon Wilson on Friday at 7:30pm.

Good Luck on Finals and Happy Holidays!!!!

The meeting was adjourned by general consent at 6:07pm.

Jessica Martin, Vice President of Administration
Student Government Association
Western Kentucky University